

Cybersecurity Research Article Submission Guidelines

Thank you for your interest in publishing your cybersecurity research article with our institute. To maintain the highest standards of quality and relevance, all submitted articles must adhere to the following guidelines. Our review process will use this document to evaluate submissions.

1. General Requirements

1.1 Topic Relevance: Articles must focus on topics related to cybersecurity, including but not limited to:

- Ethical Hacking
- Digital Forensics
- Malware Analysis
- Web Application Security
- Data Security
- Network Security
- Linux Operating System
- General
- Multipurpose

1.2 Originality: The article must be original and unpublished elsewhere. Plagiarism is strictly prohibited.

1.3 Language and Style: Articles should be written in clear and concise English, following a professional tone suitable for an academic or technical audience.

1.4 Length: The article should be between 2,500 to 5,000 words, including references.

1.5 File Format: Submissions must be in PDF format.

1.6 Author Information: Include a brief author bio (150 words max), a high-resolution photo, and contact details.

2. Article Structure

To ensure uniformity and clarity across submissions, please adhere to the following structure:

Title Page:

- **Title:** Should succinctly capture the article's focus.

- **Author(s):** List all contributing authors and their affiliations.
- **Abstract:** A summary of 150-250 words outlining the article's objectives, methodology, key findings, and conclusions.

Main Content:

1. **Introduction:**
 - Provide background information on the topic and its relevance.
 - Define the scope and objectives of the article.
2. **Tools and Environment:**
 - Detail the lab setup, tools, and software used.
 - Include system specifications, configurations, and any prerequisites.
3. **Information Gathering:**
 - Describe reconnaissance steps, tools, and techniques.
 - Present findings with annotated visuals.
4. **Exploitation:**
 - Provide a step-by-step guide to exploiting vulnerabilities, supported by screenshots or diagrams.
 - Include proof of concept (PoC) where applicable.
5. **Post-Exploitation:**
 - Highlight techniques used to demonstrate impact.
 - Discuss mitigation strategies and their effectiveness.
6. **Mitigation and Recommendations:**
 - Provide actionable steps to secure systems against the vulnerabilities discussed.
 - Offer practical advice relevant to the article's focus area.
7. **Conclusion:**
 - Summarize key insights, implications, and overall contribution to the field.

References:

- Use APA format for all citations.
- Include all tools, articles, datasets, and research sources referenced in the article.

Figures, Tables, and Diagrams:

- Incorporate clear, labeled visuals to support the content.
- Annotate images and screenshots to enhance understanding of technical steps.
- Number visuals sequentially (e.g., Figure 1, Table 1) and provide captions.

3. Submission Process

Pre-Submission Checklist:

- Ensure the article adheres to the structure outlined in Section 2.
- Verify grammatical and technical accuracy.
- Confirm all visuals are high-quality, annotated, and properly labeled.
- Cross-check citations and references for completeness and accuracy.

Submission Platform:

- Submit your article through our official portal <https://portal.icdfa.org.ng>

Review Timeline:

- Initial screening for format and compliance: **3–5 business days**.
- Peer review for technical accuracy, originality, and relevance: **10–14 business days**.
- Authors will receive feedback, including suggestions for revisions if necessary.

Revisions:

- Authors have **7 business days** to address reviewer feedback and resubmit.
- Articles failing to meet revision deadlines may be rejected.

4. Review and Approval Criteria

4.1 Relevance: The article must align with one or more of the specified categories and address current cybersecurity issues or challenges.

4.2 Originality: The article should present unique insights, approaches, or findings.

4.3 Technical Accuracy: All methodologies, data, and conclusions must be accurate and evidence-based.

4.4 Clarity and Structure: The article should be well-organized and easy to follow.

4.5 Use of Visuals: Articles must effectively use visuals such as screenshots, diagrams, and tables to support the content and enhance reader understanding.

4.6 Impact: The research should provide actionable insights and practical contributions to the cybersecurity field.

5. Publication Rights

By submitting an article, the author agrees to grant our institute the non-exclusive rights to publish the article on our portal and associated platforms. Authors retain copyright but must credit our institute if republishing elsewhere.

6. Ethics and Compliance

6.1 Ethical Considerations:

- Articles involving human subjects, personal data, or other sensitive information must adhere to ethical guidelines and institutional review board (IRB) standards.
- Ensure that all research methods, including data collection and analysis, are conducted ethically, with appropriate consent where necessary.

6.2 Data Privacy:

- If your research involves the use of personal data, you must demonstrate that you have obtained explicit consent, followed data privacy laws, and anonymized any sensitive information.

7. Conflict of Interest

7.1 Declaration of Conflicts:

- Authors must declare any financial or personal relationships that could be seen as potential conflicts of interest in relation to the article's subject.
- Failure to disclose conflicts of interest could lead to rejection of the submission.

8. Formatting Details

8.1 Font and Spacing:

- Use a **12-point Times New Roman** font for the text.
- Ensure the document is double-spaced.
- Use 1-inch margins on all sides.

8.2 Headings:

- Use appropriate headings and subheadings to clearly distinguish sections (e.g., **Introduction, Methodology, Results**, etc.).
- The main title should be centered, bolded, and in a larger font size (e.g., 16-point).

9. Copyright and Licensing

9.1 License Agreement:

- Articles may be published under specific licenses. Authors should agree to the terms upon submission, outlining reuse, redistribution, and modification rights.

10. Acknowledgments

10.1 Funding and Contributions:

- Authors must acknowledge any funding sources, research assistants, or other contributors that played a role in the research.

10.2 Thanks to Reviewers:

- If applicable, authors may acknowledge the contributions of peer reviewers who helped improve the article, particularly in the revised version.

11. Special Considerations for Submission

11.1 Supplementary Material:

- Authors may submit supplementary material such as datasets, videos, or source code related to the article.
- Ensure supplementary material is clearly labeled and referenced within the main article.

11.2 Language Editing:

- If you are submitting an article in English, and English is not your first language, you may be required to have the article professionally edited to meet the publication's language standards.

12. Post-Publication

12.1 Revisions After Publication:

- Once published, the article may undergo post-publication revisions based on additional feedback or new developments in the field.

- Clarify the process for handling corrections, retractions, and amendments post-publication.

13. Author's Rights and Responsibilities

13.1 Rights of the Author:

- Authors retain the right to use their article in future works or presentations, as long as they give appropriate credit to the original publication.

13.2 Author's Responsibilities:

- Authors are responsible for ensuring that the article meets all submission guidelines and ethical standards.
- They must respond to reviewer feedback within the allotted time and ensure that revisions are made accordingly.

Contact Us

For any inquiries or assistance, please contact us at:

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We look forward to receiving your submissions and contributing to the advancement of cybersecurity knowledge!